

SEO + AEO + GEO

DEVELOPER IMPLEMENTATION & PRE-LAUNCH CHECKLIST

Purpose: A practical implementation checklist for developers covering technical SEO, on-page SEO, performance, structured data, Answer Engine Optimization (AEO), Generative Engine Optimization (GEO), local SEO, analytics, and final QA.

1. TECHNICAL SEO

Website Foundation
■ HTTPS enabled on all pages
■ HTTP → HTTPS redirect configured
■ WWW/non-WWW version standardized
■ Canonical URL configured
■ No duplicate URLs
■ Clean, readable URL structure
■ URLs use lowercase
■ No unnecessary parameters in indexable URLs
■ 404 page implemented
■ 301 redirects configured for changed URLs
■ No redirect chains or loops
■ No broken internal links
■ SEO-critical content is available without depending on client-side JavaScript
Crawl & Indexing
■ robots.txt created and reviewed
■ Important pages are not blocked
■ XML sitemap created
■ Sitemap submitted to Google Search Console
■ Sitemap submitted to Bing Webmaster Tools
■ Sitemap contains only canonical/indexable URLs
■ noindex applied to private/thin/duplicate pages where required
■ No accidental noindex/nofollow on important pages
■ Correct robots meta tags and X-Robots-Tag headers

2. ON-PAGE SEO

■ Unique SEO title for every important page
■ Unique meta description
■ One clear H1
■ Proper H2/H3 hierarchy
■ Primary topic covered naturally
■ Related entities/topics covered
■ Descriptive URL
■ Canonical tag

- Open Graph metadata
 - Twitter/X card metadata
 - Relevant internal links
 - Relevant external references where useful
 - Image alt text
 - Descriptive image filenames
 - Structured data where applicable
- Title: unique, relevant, brand-aware, natural, not keyword stuffed
- Meta description: unique, descriptive, relevant, useful CTA where appropriate

3. CONTENT SEO

- Original content
- Search intent matched
- Clear introduction
- Helpful headings
- Short readable paragraphs
- Lists/tables where useful
- FAQs where genuinely useful
- Author information where relevant
- Published/updated date where relevant
- Related content
- Internal linking
- Breadcrumbs
- Entity names clearly identifiable
- Location information where relevant
- Contact/business information where relevant

4. INTERNAL LINKING

- Important pages receive internal links
- No orphan pages
- Navigation links are crawlable
- Breadcrumb navigation implemented
- Related-content links implemented
- Anchor text describes destination
- Avoid excessive exact-match anchor text
- Important commercial pages linked from relevant content
- Category → subcategory → product/service hierarchy implemented

5. CORE WEB VITALS & PERFORMANCE

- LCP optimized
- INP optimized

- CLS optimized
- Images compressed
- WebP/AVIF used where appropriate
- Responsive images implemented
- Lazy loading for below-the-fold images
- Critical images prioritized
- CSS and JavaScript optimized
- Unused JavaScript removed
- Code splitting implemented
- Fonts optimized
- Browser caching configured
- CDN configured where appropriate
- GZIP/Brotli enabled
- Server response time optimized

6. MOBILE SEO

- Fully responsive
- Mobile-first layout
- No horizontal scrolling
- Text readable without zoom
- Buttons/touch targets usable
- Mobile navigation crawlable
- Same important content on mobile and desktop
- Images work correctly on mobile
- Forms work correctly
- Popups/interstitials do not obstruct important content

7. JAVASCRIPT / SPA SEO

- Important content is server-rendered or otherwise crawlable
- SSR/SSG implemented where appropriate
- Dynamic pages generate unique metadata
- Dynamic titles and descriptions work
- Canonical URLs work
- Sitemap dynamically updated
- Robots rules work
- Structured data renders correctly
- Client-side routing does not create indexing problems
- 404 routes return actual 404 status
- Redirects return correct HTTP status
- Important content is not loaded only after user interaction

8. STRUCTURED DATA / SCHEMA

- Organization
- LocalBusiness
- WebSite
- WebPage
- BreadcrumbList
- Article / BlogPosting
- Product
- Service
- FAQPage where appropriate
- HowTo where appropriate
- Review
- Event
- JobPosting
- Person
- VideoObject
- Course
- SoftwareApplication

Schema QA: JSON-LD preferred; valid JSON; required properties populated; data matches visible content; no fake reviews; no misleading or duplicate/conflicting schema

9. AEO — ANSWER ENGINE OPTIMIZATION

- Important questions identified
- Direct answers provided
- Question-based headings used
- Answers placed immediately after questions
- Definitions clearly written
- Step-by-step explanations available
- FAQs implemented where genuinely useful
- Tables used for comparisons
- Important facts stated clearly
- Supporting evidence/references provided where appropriate
- Question-answer content available in HTML
- Important answers are not hidden behind JavaScript
- FAQ content is crawlable
- Entity information is consistent
- Organization information is consistent
- Author information available where relevant
- About page implemented
- Contact page implemented

10. GEO — GENERATIVE ENGINE OPTIMIZATION

- Company name clearly defined
- Company description clearly defined
- Products/services clearly defined
- Locations clearly defined
- Founder/leadership information clearly defined
- Brand relationships clearly defined
- Industry/category clearly defined
- Contact information consistent
- Social profiles linked
- External profiles consistent
- Same company name used consistently
- Organization schema implemented
- sameAs links implemented where appropriate
- About page
- Contact page
- Team/leadership pages
- Product/service pages
- Company history where relevant
- Press/media page where relevant
- Relevant authoritative external mentions

11. GEO CONTENT STRUCTURE

- What is it?
- Who is it for?
- What problem does it solve?
- How does it work?
- Key features
- Benefits
- Pricing/cost information if applicable
- Implementation/process
- Frequently asked questions
- Examples/use cases
- Location/service availability
- Company information
- Contact/CTA

12. AI CITATION READINESS

- Important claims supported by evidence
- Statistics have sources
- Research has references

- Dates are clearly mentioned
- Facts are separated from opinions
- Product specifications are explicit
- Service capabilities are explicit
- No ambiguous marketing claims
- No unsupported “best”, “#1”, or “leading” claims
- Original research published where possible
- Case studies published
- Real examples available

13. LOCAL SEO + GEO

- Google Business Profile
- Bing Places
- Consistent business name
- Consistent address
- Consistent phone number
- Business hours
- Location pages
- Embedded map where appropriate
- LocalBusiness schema
- Service-area information
- Local reviews
- Location-specific content

14. IMAGE SEO

- Descriptive filenames
- Proper alt text
- Image dimensions specified
- WebP/AVIF
- Lazy loading
- Image sitemap where useful
- No unnecessarily huge images
- Relevant captions where useful
- Images represent actual content
- Important text is not only inside images

15. VIDEO SEO

- Video title
- Video description
- Thumbnail
- VideoObject schema where appropriate

- Captions/subtitles
- Transcript
- Video sitemap where useful
- Relevant videos embedded on supporting pages
- YouTube/social links where appropriate

16. SECURITY & SEO

- HTTPS
- Valid SSL certificate
- No mixed content
- Security headers
- No exposed admin pages
- No sensitive information indexed
- Staging site blocked from indexing
- Development URLs blocked
- Test accounts/pages blocked
- .env files never exposed

17. INTERNATIONAL / MULTI-LANGUAGE SEO

- Language attribute
- Separate language URLs
- hreflang
- Correct canonical per language
- Language-specific sitemap
- Translated metadata
- Translated structured data
- No automatic incorrect language redirects

18. ANALYTICS & SEARCH CONSOLE

- Google Search Console
- Bing Webmaster Tools
- Google Analytics
- Conversion tracking
- Search query monitoring
- Index coverage monitoring
- Sitemap monitoring
- Core Web Vitals monitoring
- 404 monitoring
- Redirect monitoring
- Organic traffic monitoring

19. DEVELOPER PRE-LAUNCH CHECK — MUST PASS

- HTTPS
- Robots.txt
- XML Sitemap
- Canonical
- Meta title
- Meta description
- H1
- 404
- 301 redirects
- Mobile responsive
- Page speed
- Core Web Vitals
- Structured data
- Internal links
- Image optimization
- Open Graph
- Search Console
- Analytics
- No accidental noindex
- No staging URLs indexed

20. AEO + GEO FINAL CHECK

- Can Google understand what the company does?
- Can an AI system understand what the company does?
- Can an AI system identify the company's products/services?
- Can an AI system identify the company's location?
- Can an AI system identify the company's leadership?
- Are important questions answered directly?
- Are answers available in crawlable HTML?
- Are important facts clearly structured?
- Are claims supported by evidence?
- Is company information consistent across the web?
- Are entities clearly defined?
- Is structured data valid?
- Are important pages internally connected?
- Can search engines crawl and index the important pages?

21. DEVELOPER DELIVERY STATUS

Area	Pending	In Progress	Completed
Technical SEO	■	■	■
On-Page SEO	■	■	■
Performance	■	■	■
Mobile SEO	■	■	■
Schema	■	■	■
AEO	■	■	■
GEO	■	■	■
Local SEO	■	■	■
Analytics	■	■	■
Search Console	■	■	■
Final QA	■	■	■

22. RECOMMENDED IMPLEMENTATION ORDER

1. Technical SEO
2. On-Page SEO
3. Performance / Core Web Vitals
4. Structured Data / Schema
5. AEO
6. GEO / Entity Optimization
7. Local SEO
8. Analytics & Search Console
9. Final Crawl / Indexing QA

Developer Sign-off: _____ Date: _____ Project: _____